

Real Estate Accounting System - \$22,000 Budget Allocation

Budget Reality Check

With \$22,000 over 6 months, we have approximately **\$3,667 per month**. This is a very limited budget for a complex accounting system, so we'll need to adopt a highly focused MVP approach.

Recommended Development Strategy

1. Ultra-Lean Team Structure

Role	Time Allocation	Monthly Cost	Total (6 months)
Full-Stack Developer (Remote)	Full-time	\$2,000	\$12,000
Part-time Senior Developer/Architect	20 hours/month	\$800	\$4,800
UI/UX Designer	40 hours total	-	\$2,000
QA/Testing	60 hours total	-	\$1,800
Project Management	Self-managed	\$0	\$0
Infrastructure & Tools	-	\$233/month	\$1,400
Total	-	-	\$22,000

2. Phased MVP Development Plan

Phase 1: Core Foundation (Months 1-2)

Budget: \$7,334

Features:

- Basic user authentication

- Simple property management (CRUD)
- Basic tenant management
- Basic transaction recording
- Simple database structure

Resource Allocation:

- Full-Stack Developer: \$4,000
- Senior Developer Guidance: \$1,600
- UI/UX Design (20 hours): \$1,000
- Infrastructure Setup: \$734

Deliverables:

- Working authentication system
- Basic dashboard
- Property and tenant modules
- Simple transaction entry

Phase 2: Essential Accounting (Months 3-4)

Budget: \$7,333

Features:

- Basic general ledger
- Simple billing generation
- Basic payment recording
- Simple reporting (income/expense)

Resource Allocation:

- Full-Stack Developer: \$4,000
- Senior Developer Guidance: \$1,600
- UI/UX Design (20 hours): \$1,000
- Infrastructure: \$466
- Initial Testing: \$267

Deliverables:

- Functional GL system
- Monthly billing capability
- Basic financial reports
- Payment tracking

Phase 3: Polish & Launch (Months 5-6)

Budget: \$7,333

Features:

- Basic tenant portal
- Essential reports
- Bug fixes and optimization
- Basic documentation

Resource Allocation:

- Full-Stack Developer: \$4,000

- Senior Developer Review: \$1,600
- QA Testing: \$1,533
- Infrastructure: \$200

Deliverables:

- Stable MVP application
- Tenant login portal
- Core reporting suite
- Deployment to production

Technology Stack (Cost-Optimized)

Frontend

- React (Create React App)
- Material-UI (free components)
- Redux Toolkit
- Axios

Backend

- Django + Django REST Framework
- SQLite (development) / PostgreSQL (production)
- Gunicorn
- Basic Celery setup (if needed)

Infrastructure

- DigitalOcean Droplet (\$20/month)
- GitHub (free tier)
- Cloudflare (free SSL)
- SendGrid (free tier for emails)

Development Approach

1. Remote Team

- Hire from regions with lower costs (Eastern Europe, Southeast Asia, or Latin America)
- Focus on experienced freelancers who can work independently

2. Open Source First

- Use established open-source libraries
- Leverage Django admin for internal interfaces
- Use free UI components

3. Simplified Architecture

- Monolithic application (no microservices)
- Minimal third-party integrations
- Basic authentication (no SSO initially)

Feature Prioritization Matrix

Feature	Priority	Include in MVP	Defer
User Authentication	High	✓	
Property Management	High	✓	
Tenant Management	High	✓	
Basic GL	High	✓	
Transaction Entry	High	✓	
Monthly Billing	High	✓	
Basic Reports	Medium	✓	
Tenant Portal	Medium	✓ (basic)	
Bank Reconciliation	Low		✓
Multi-currency	Low		✓
Advanced Reports	Low		✓
Audit Trail	Low		✓
Batch Processing	Low		✓

Risk Mitigation

Technical Risks

- Keep architecture simple
- Use proven technologies
- Regular code reviews by senior developer

Budget Risks

- Fixed-price contracts with developers
- Weekly progress reviews

- Strict scope management

Timeline Risks

- Focus on core features only
- Defer nice-to-have features
- Use agile sprints (2-week cycles)

Post-MVP Roadmap

Once the MVP is launched and generating revenue:

1. **Months 7-9:** Add bank reconciliation and audit trail (\$15,000)
2. **Months 10-12:** Advanced reporting and multi-currency (\$20,000)
3. **Year 2:** Scale team and add enterprise features

Expected MVP Limitations

With this budget, the MVP will have:

- Basic functionality only
- Limited customization options
- Simple UI/UX
- Minimal automation
- Basic reporting
- Limited user roles

Success Metrics

- Launch functional MVP within 6 months

- Support 5-10 properties initially
- Handle basic accounting needs
- Generate first revenue by month 7

Recommendations

1. **Consider Bootstrapping:** Use initial revenue to fund further development
2. **Seek Additional Funding:** Present MVP to investors for Series A
3. **Partnership Opportunities:** Partner with existing property management companies
4. **Revenue Model:** Start with \$50-100/month per property pricing

Monthly Budget Breakdown

Month	Development	Infrastructure	Design/Testing	Total
1	\$2,800	\$467	\$500	\$3,767
2	\$2,800	\$267	\$500	\$3,567
3	\$2,800	\$233	\$500	\$3,533
4	\$2,800	\$233	\$767	\$3,800
5	\$2,800	\$100	\$767	\$3,667
6	\$2,800	\$100	\$766	\$3,666
Total	\$16,800	\$1,400	\$3,800	\$22,000

Critical Success Factors

1. **Experienced Developer:** Must hire someone who can work independently
2. **Scope Discipline:** Strictly limit features to essentials
3. **Rapid Iterations:** Weekly releases and feedback cycles

4. **Early User Testing:** Get feedback from real users by month 3
5. **Revenue Focus:** Design for quick path to first paying customers

Alternative Approach: No-Code/Low-Code

Consider using platforms like:

- Bubble.io for rapid development
- Airtable for database
- Zapier for integrations
- Retool for internal tools

This could potentially deliver more features within the budget but with limitations on customization and scalability.